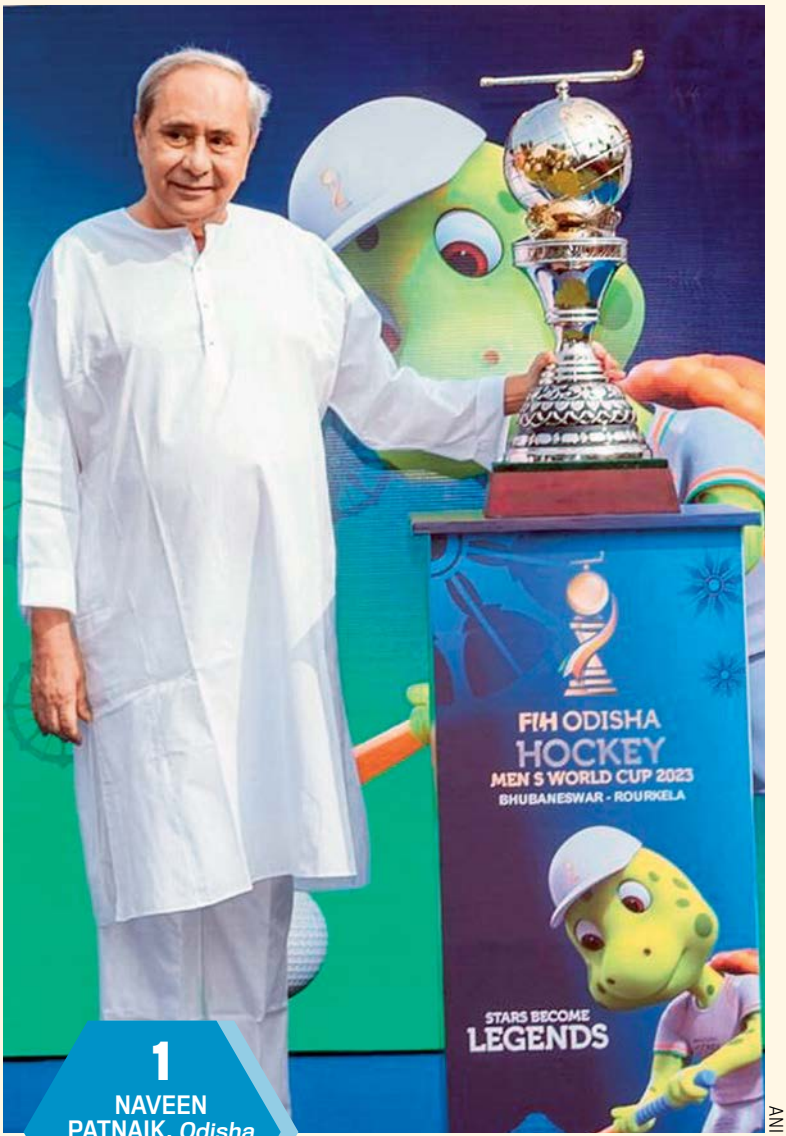
asked to rate the performance of the 30 chief ministers in India, 43 per cent of them, up from 39.1 per cent in January, rated Yogi as the No. 1. With just 19 per cent respondents backing him, Delhi CM Arvind Kejriwal stood a distant second.

Yogi's popularity is not hard to decipher. He has created a new model of governance by blending Hindutva politics with a tough stand on law and order. If he is using bulldozers to punish criminals, he is also wooing industrialists to set up shop in his state. His methods have caught the people's fancy, even though political experts and critics remain unsure. And some results are now showing on the ground. In 2022-23, UP accounted for the highest share of 16.2 per cent, or Rs 43,180 crore, in the total cost of projects sanctioned by banks and financial institutions in India.

But when it comes to popularity within his home state, the UP CM slips to seventh position even though he commands the support of a healthy 47 per cent of the respondents, who expressed satisfaction with his performance. His West Bengal counterpart Mamata Banerjee, who is rated the third most popular CM across India, doesn't even find a place among the top 10 when the performance of these chief ministers is evaluated by the respondents from their home states. The topper on this list is Odisha CM Naveen Patnaik with 61.3 per cent of the respondents from his state expressing satisfaction with his performance. The five-time CM, however, has some reasons to worry, just a year before Odisha goes to the assembly polls. For, his satisfaction ratings have been on a downward trajectory. If it stood at 78.1 per cent in the MOTN poll conducted in August 2022, it slipped to 73.2 per cent in January 2023.

Chhattisgarh CM Bhupesh Baghel, on the other hand, has recorded a gradual rise in his ratings—from 53.3 per cent a year ago to 55.7 per cent in January 2023 to 59.1 per cent now. This makes him the second most popular CM within the home state, which can only be heartening news as the state goes to polls this year. He is closely followed by Kejriwal at 57.7 per cent. Gujarat CM Bhupendrabhai Patel, meanwhile, sees a sudden jump in his satisfaction ratings to 55.3 per cent from 43.6 per cent six months back. He is also the highest ranked among all the CMs from the Bharatiya Janata Party. ■



ANI

1 NAVEEN PATNAIK, *Odisha*
61.3% [73.2%]

Q. MOST POPULAR CM (IN HOME STATE)

Respondents in each of the 30 states were asked to rate their own CM



3 ARVIND KEJRIWAL *Delhi*
57.7% [69.2%]



4 BHUPENDRABHAI PATEL *Gujarat*
55.3% [43.6%]



2 BHUPESH BAGHEL *Chhattisgarh*
59.1% [55.7%]



5 HIMANTA BISWA SARMA, *Assam*
49.2% [68.3%]

Aug. '23 figures in bold; Jan. '23 in [ ]
Note: *Respondents of every state were asked to evaluate the performance of their own CM. For instance, 61.3 per cent of the respondents out of 3,760 from Odisha said they were satisfied with Naveen Patnaik, while 59.1 per cent of the 6,703 respondents from Chhattisgarh expressed satisfaction with Bhupesh Baghel's performance*